ARTH THAKKAR

Information Systems Engineering | Identity and Access Management | Microsoft 365 and Intune | Automation and AI

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Information systems professional with 5+ years designing, securing and automating enterprise IT for organizations of up to 20,000+ users, including Walmart Global Tech, McCain Foods and Deloitte. Specializes in Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD) identity and access management: hybrid identity, joiner-mover-leaver, Conditional Access, PIM, access reviews and SOX ITGC audits, backed by completed SC-300 training. Builds version-controlled automation with PowerShell, Claude Code and GitHub, and partners with Oracle IT and HR to remediate business-critical automation issues. Results include 40% fewer provisioning errors, 35% fewer access-related incidents and zero missed SOX audit cycles.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Identity and Access: Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD), Active Directory, Hybrid Identity (Entra Connect Sync, Cloud Sync), Conditional Access, MFA, Passwordless (Windows Hello for Business, FIDO2, Authenticator), SSPR, Entra ID Protection, RBAC and Custom Roles, Administrative Units, Dynamic Groups, B2B Guest Access, Zero Trust, Least Privilege

Identity Governance: Privileged Identity Management (PIM), Access Reviews, Entitlement Management and Access Packages, Lifecycle Workflows, Joiner-Mover-Leaver, Sign-in and Audit Logs, SOX ITGC Audit Evidence, Segregation of Duties

SSO and App Access: Enterprise Apps, SSO (SAML, OIDC, OAuth 2.0), App Registrations, User and Admin Consent

Automation and AI: PowerShell, Claude Code (CLI), Anthropic Claude, AWS Bedrock, LLM API Integration, Prompt Engineering, Human-in-the-Loop Validation, ServiceNow Workflows, Git, GitHub (Authenticated CLI, Branching)

Microsoft 365 and Azure: Microsoft 365, Exchange Online, SharePoint, Teams, Licensing, Microsoft Azure

Endpoint and Security: Microsoft Intune, Jamf Pro, SCCM (Microsoft Configuration Manager), Apple Business Manager, Windows 10/11, macOS, iOS, Microsoft Defender, EDR, Defender for Cloud Apps, Software Testing and Deployment

Infrastructure and Networking: Windows Server (Monitoring, Patching), Backup and Recovery (Veeam, Barracuda), Switching and Fabric Networks, TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP, VPN, Wireless Access Points, Ekahau Site Surveys, Badge Access

ITSM and Operations: ITIL, ServiceNow (Incident, Problem, Change, Request, CMDB, HAM Pro), Root Cause Analysis, Evergreen Lifecycle Refresh, Vendor Management, Executive (VIP) Support, Teams Rooms, Zoom Rooms, User Training

Development: Docker, React, Node.js, PostgreSQL, Prisma, Vitest, Jest

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Systems Specialist (Infrastructure Site Lead), ITOT Team **Sep 2025 – Present**

Extreme Networks | Toronto, ON

- Engineer AI-assisted automation with Claude Code (CLI) and authenticated GitHub integration, maintaining version-controlled repositories for offline (local and scheduled) and online (API and cloud-connected) automations.
- Partner with Oracle IT and Human Resources to diagnose and remediate automation issues affecting business-critical enterprise workflows, leading root cause analysis, coordinating fixes across teams and reducing manual rework.
- Drive AI, data and automation use cases with Anthropic Claude, PowerShell and ServiceNow workflows, applying human-in-the-loop validation to improve efficiency, accuracy and decision-making.
- Co-own monthly SOX ITGC access audits for 10,000+ users with zero missed audit cycles, collecting access evidence and governing hybrid Active Directory and Entra ID with least privilege.
- Act as onsite network lead with no local NetOps staff: rack and install switches, connect edge switches to core across the fabric network, validate desk jacks and keep wireless access points online.
- Administer site Windows servers (monitoring, patching, maintenance) and local backups, performing data restorations to confirm recovery readiness; manage badge access systems with Security and Facilities to meet global IT standards.
- Serve as the primary face of IT for the Canadian office, delivering white-glove VIP support to senior leadership, running Teams Rooms and Zoom Rooms for town halls, and testing software releases before rollout.
- Run Evergreen PC, network and server refresh with 5 vendors (Dell, Apple, Lenovo, SHI, CDW), reconciling ServiceNow HAM Pro and CMDB asset records against Intune, Jamf Pro and SCCM.

Regional Technology Specialist (IT Operations Site Lead) **Aug 2024 – Sep 2025**
McCain Foods Limited | Toronto, ON

- Administered Microsoft Entra Privileged Identity Management (PIM) for Entra ID and Azure roles, converting standing admin access to eligible, just-in-time activation with approval, MFA, justification and time limits.
- Built Entra ID Governance access packages and recurring access reviews for privileged roles, groups and guest users.
- Designed and enforced Intune compliance, configuration and app-protection policies for the corporate iOS fleet, from Apple Business Manager enrollment through retirement.
- Supported C-suite and global executives as the Toronto head office's primary technology representative, and served as sole liaison to global IT infrastructure teams for a 20,000-employee organization.
- Completed an Ekahau wireless site survey for a new access point installation; managed asset inventory, Evergreen refresh, vendor pricing and warranty claims, and led technical delivery of executive town halls in Teams Rooms.

System Support Specialist II (Technical Site Lead) **May 2023 – Aug 2024**
Walmart Global Tech | Toronto, ON

- Owned the identity lifecycle for 5,000+ identities in a 20,000+ user hybrid environment.
- Reduced provisioning errors by 40% by standardizing joiner-mover-leaver processes and building account and group templates adopted for new site launches.
- Resolved 1,000+ incidents per month across identity, endpoint, hardware and network platforms at 100% SLA compliance in ServiceNow; improved global triage efficiency by 25% through root cause analysis.
- Secured Windows and macOS endpoints with SCCM and Jamf Pro, and led ServiceNow CMDB inventory audits.

Information Technology Analyst **Apr 2022 – May 2023**
Deloitte | Toronto, ON

- Ran joiner-mover-leaver processes for a 10,000-user practice, coordinating hardware, software and badge access with Facilities and revoking access promptly at exit.
- Automated Tier 2 and Tier 3 access resolution with PowerShell; rebuilt the knowledge base and escalation procedures and trained staff on applications and security practices.
- Supported partners and senior leaders on devices, Microsoft 365 and Teams meeting rooms at 95% customer satisfaction.

Systems Administrator (Identity and Access Management) **Oct 2021 – Mar 2022**
Audcomp (Managed Service Provider) | Ancaster, ON

- Architected client Microsoft 365 and Azure configurations, licensing and identity, reducing access-related incidents by 35% by redesigning roles and security groups across multi-tenant environments at 99.9% uptime.
- Designed and managed client backup and recovery with Barracuda, Veeam and Microsoft cloud backup; ran quarterly backup audits and cloud-to-cloud restores to verify recovery readiness.
- Deployed Microsoft Defender and EDR baselines to meet government audit requirements for public-sector clients.
- Supported 10+ clients, including the City of Hamilton, City of Burlington and ZipRecruiter.

CERTIFICATIONS

- **Microsoft Identity and Access Administrator (SC-300)**: training complete, exam pending — In progress
- **Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900)** — 2024
- **Microsoft Certified: Security, Compliance, and Identity Fundamentals (SC-900)** — 2023

PROJECTS

AI Cloud Lead, MISE – AI-Powered Inventory Management Platform **May 2026 – Jul 2026**
UMGC Capstone | github.com/UMGCCAPSTONE

- Built a restaurant inventory platform (React, Node.js, PostgreSQL, Docker) with a 6-person team, featuring Claude menu recommendations on AWS Bedrock; designed the Prisma data model, migrations and seed data in GitHub.
- Developed the React inventory add, edit and delete flow, CSV export and dashboard API endpoints with Vitest and Jest tests; recognized by the instructor as one of the most innovative projects in 10 years.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science **Aug 2026**
University of Maryland Global Campus | GPA 3.88/4.00 | Dean's List (four terms) | Completed while working full-time

Diploma, Computer Systems Technician – Network Systems **Apr 2021**
Mohawk College | Hamilton, ON